BRAIN 01

Alpha-GPC

Choline-containing compound (choline alfoscerate), described in research as a precursor of acetylcholine



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Dietary supplement (choline compound)	Dementia, memory, focus, strength	Controlled human trials	Dietary supplement · not an approved drug

STUDIED FOR

- **Alzheimer's disease** — HUMAN
- **Mild memory problems** — HUMAN
- **Thinking tests** — HUMAN
- **Muscle force** — HUMAN

Stroke association. A Korean health-records study of 12 million adults linked alpha-GPC use to more strokes. It shows an association, not cause.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Alpha-GPC ▶ Choline source ▶ Acetylcholine ▶ Memory, thinking

- Described in research as a **precursor of acetylcholine**, a nerve messenger
- Lab and animal work was **not reviewed** on the page
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Placebo trials in dementia: 261 and 100 people
- Small, short studies in healthy young men
- Stroke link in a records study (not a trial)

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Cause of the stroke link
- Effects in healthy men

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	By mouth (capsules) in trials
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	Dietary supplement (US); authorised medicine in Italy
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
ADAS-Cog and dementia scales; side effects, lab tests	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	No approved drug; sold as dietary supplement
AIFA	Italy: authorised (Gliatilin, Delecit)
EMA	No centrally authorised medicine
WADA	Not listed

REFERENCES

1. Clin Ther, choline alfoscerate in Alzheimer's disease, Jan 2003
2. BMC Geriatr, alpha-GPC in mild cognitive impairment, Sep 2024
3. JAMA Netw Open, alpha-GPC use and stroke risk, Nov 2021

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